

Chapter-07

Motivation

Motivation refers to the internal processes that initiate, direct, and sustain goal-directed behavior. It is what drives individuals to act in certain ways, whether to fulfill basic needs, achieve personal goals, or pursue higher aspirations.

Example of Motivation Differences

A student may struggle to read a school-assigned book but finish a bestselling novel in a day. The difference? **Motivation!** They are more interested in the novel, so they put in more effort.

Motivation in the Workplace

- Some people are naturally motivated all the time (**a personality trait**).
- Others feel motivated only in certain situations (**a temporary state**).
- Companies aim to increase motivation to improve **job performance** and align employees' efforts with organizational goals.

Theories of Motivation

Different theories explain why people are motivated:

1. **Need-based theories** – People work to satisfy personal needs (e.g., job satisfaction).
2. **Goal-based theories** – People work to achieve job-related goals (e.g., meeting deadlines).

Motivation and Remote Work

- Some remote workers stay motivated because they enjoy flexibility.
- Others struggle without structure, leading to low motivation.

By understanding motivation, organizations can create a better work environment that encourages employees to stay **focused, productive, and satisfied**

Hierarchy of Needs Theory

Maslow's hierarchy of needs is a well-known theory about what motivates people. It suggests that every person has different levels of needs that they try to fulfill, one after the other. **These needs are often shown as a pyramid with five levels:**

1. **Physiological needs** – Basic things like food, water, and shelter that keep us alive.
2. **Safety needs** – Feeling secure, safe, and protected from harm.
3. **Social (Belongingness) needs** – The need for love, friendship, and feeling like we belong.
4. **Esteem needs** – Wanting to feel good about ourselves, gain respect, and be recognized by others.
5. **Self-actualization** – The desire to grow, reach our full potential, and achieve personal goals.

Some people have suggested a sixth level, called **intrinsic values**, but it hasn't been widely accepted.

Many people believe that we move up the hierarchy step by step—once one need is satisfied, we focus on the next. However, Maslow himself didn't say that the needs always follow a strict order. Sometimes, different needs can be important at the same time.



Even though the theory is popular, especially in business and management, research doesn't strongly support it. Scientists haven't studied it much since the 1960s, and many believe it doesn't fully explain what motivates people at work. However, because it is simple and easy to understand, people still use it when discussing motivation.

McClelland's Theory of Needs

McClelland's Theory of Needs explains motivation based on three key needs:

1. Need for Achievement (nAch) – The desire to do well and be successful.

- These people love challenges.
- They set high goals and work hard to reach them.
- They like feedback to know how they're doing.

2. Need for Affiliation (nAff) – The need to build relationships and be liked.

- These people enjoy working with others.
- They like making friends and keeping peace in a group.
- They avoid conflict and want to feel accepted.

3. Need for Power (nPow) – The desire to influence or control others.

- These people like leadership roles.
- They enjoy competition and winning.
- Some want power for themselves, while others want it to help the team or company grow.

Expectancy Theory

Expectancy Theory (Victor Vroom) explains how individuals make decisions about their behavior based on expected outcomes. It says people will work hard when they believe three things:

1. **Expectancy (Effort → Performance):** "If I try hard, I will perform well." This depends on skills, resources, and confidence.
2. **Instrumentality (Performance → Reward):** "If I perform well, I will get a reward." Employees need to believe that good work leads to recognition or benefits.
3. **Valence (Reward → Personal Goals):** "Do I even want this reward?" The reward must be something the person values.

For example, imagine a company offers an "Employee of the Month" parking spot. Some employees might be very motivated to win it (if parking is difficult), while others might not care at all. Expectancy Theory helps explain why some employees work harder than others—people put in effort when they believe it will lead to rewards they actually want.

